

The Connected Post

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FEATURES

Billy Bragg says London march sends message to far right: “The people of Britain will not allow themselves to be fooled by such shysters”

Max Pilley · NME

Billy Bragg has spoken about yesterday’s massive march in London, saying it will send a message to the “shysters” on the far right in the UK.

READ MORE: Zack Polanski: “We have a right wing media that seeks to divide us, distract us and claim that trans people are our problems”

The protest on Saturday (March 28) was organised by the Together Alliance and they claimed that half a million people took to the streets of central London to stand up for unity and to build public awareness about the growing threat of the far right in the UK and beyond.

Bragg was one of the performers to play on the ‘House Against Hate’ stage that was assembled in Trafalgar Square for the demonstration, alongside the likes of Self Esteem, Hot Chip, Jessie Ware and Katy B, and he has now shared a reflection on the experience.

Writing on Instagram, Bragg said that he felt “greatly inspired” by the protest, adding: “The concerns that people have about rising cost of living, widening gaps between the rich and poor, an over-stretched NHS, the lack of affordable housing and the effects of the climate crisis cannot be solved by rounding up people of colour and forcing them to ‘remigrate’.”

Addressing the target of the demonstration, he continued: “Between now and the next election, there will be politicians of the Far-age right and the far right who will bang the drum for remigration in the hope that no one will ask them how they intend to address those aforementioned problems. Yesterday suggests that the people of Britain will not allow themselves to be fooled by such shysters.”

[View this post on Instagram](#)

He likened the event to the Rock Against Racism and Anti-Nazi League campaigns of the late ‘70s, and noted that he was joined on stage yesterday by The Specials’ Jerry Dammers, another veteran of those earlier movements.

“What I found most encouraging yesterday was the number of young people in attendance,” Bragg added. “I hope yesterday saw the introduction of a new generation of activists whose lives will be changed by what they saw and heard on the march. Because by being there, they have joined an anti-fascist tradition that stretches back not just to Rock Against Racism in the 1970s, but all the way back to the Battle of Cable Street in 1936.”

Billy Bragg on stage at the Together Alliance march

Where he also pays tribute to the people of Minneapolis who stood up against ICE

“Last year’s Unite the Kingdom march organised by Tommy Robinson was the most divisive event in the country over the last ten years”... pic.twitter.com/kj1R2jtXy9

— Farrukh (@implausibleblog) March 29, 2026

During his performance at the rally, Bragg addressed the crowd, saying: “Last year’s Unite the Kingdom march... organised by Tommy Robinson was the most divisive event in the country over the last ten years. Commentators were saying these people have justified concerns – that may be the case, but their solutions are not justifiable in any way. Remigration, the forced deportation of our fellow citizens, we’ve seen what that looks like in the USA. And if it does come to that in this country, then we will have to be as courageous as the people of Minneapolis.”

Others to take to the ‘House Against Hate’ stage included the Green Party leader Zack Polanski and Hannah Spencer MP, who won the hotly-contested Gorton and Denton by-election for the Greens last month.

Polanski told the crowd: “Go back to your communities, to the community centres, to your trade unions, to your friends, to your neighbours. We must organise in our communities. Local elections are coming in just a few weeks’ time.”

“There have been dark times, I know people have been scared and we have been afraid, but days like this are here to send a message – a message to Tommy Robinson, to Nigel Farage, to those who appease them,” he continued. “We will defeat hate. It’s time to make hope normal again.”

[View this post on Instagram](#)

Actress and presenter Jameela Jamil was also at the protest and shared her own reflections afterwards on Instagram. “I have been really struggling lately,” she wrote. “Drowning in hopelessness. Sometimes I think protests don’t make a difference because the people at the top don’t care about what we think or want, or how we feel. But today reminded me of why they’re important. Because of MORALE for US not the people at the top. It reminds you that good TRULY outweighs bad. That hate is loud but small. That everyone from every walk of life can come together for such a wholesome cause. I love this country. Today was FUN. It made hatred look so crusty, boring and stressful. Everyone today was hot and cool and the vibes were immaculate.”

The demonstration was in part a response to the emergence of far-right protests over the last two years. In September 2025, the Metropolitan police estimated that between 110,000 and 150,000 people attended the so-called “unite the kingdom” rally in central London, where Tommy Robinson and Elon Musk were among the speakers. An estimated 5000 anti-fascist counter-protesters faced the far-right activist-led rally that day.

What is Blockchain: Everything You Need to Know (2022)

Unknown · TechCrunch

If you want to pay online, you need to register an account and provide credit card information. If you don't have a credit card, you can pay with bank transfer. With the rise of cryptocurrencies, these methods may become old.

Imagine a world in which you can do transactions and many other things without having to give your personal information. A world in which you don't need to rely on banks or governments anymore. Sounds amazing, right? That's exactly what blockchain technology allows us to do.

It's like your computer's hard drive. Blockchain is a technology that lets you store data in digital blocks, which are connected together like links in a chain.

Blockchain technology was originally invented in 1991 by two mathematicians, Stuart Haber and W. Scot Stornetta. They first proposed the system to ensure that timestamps could not be tampered with.

A few years later, in 1998, software developer Nick Szabo proposed using a similar kind of technology to secure a digital payments system he called "Bit Gold." However, this innovation was not adopted until Satoshi Nakamoto claimed to have invented the first Blockchain and Bitcoin.

So, What is Blockchain?

A blockchain is a distributed database shared between the nodes of a computer network. It saves information in digital format. Many people first heard of blockchain technology when they started to look up information about bitcoin.

Blockchain is used in cryptocurrency systems to ensure secure, decentralized records of transactions.

Blockchain allowed people to guarantee the fidelity and security of a record of data without the need for a third party to ensure accuracy.

To understand how a blockchain works, Consider these basic steps:

Blockchain collects information in "blocks".

A block has a storage capacity, and once it's used up, it can be closed and linked to a previously served block.

Blocks form chains, which are called "Blockchains."

More information will be added to the block with the most content until its capacity is full. The process repeats itself.

Each block in the chain has an exact timestamp and can't be changed.

Let's get to know more about the blockchain.

How does blockchain work?

Blockchain records digital information and distributes it across the network without changing it. The information is distributed among many users and stored in an immutable, permanent ledger that can't be changed or destroyed. That's why blockchain is also called "Distributed Ledger Technology" or DLT.

Here's how it works:

Someone or a computer will transact

The transaction is transmitted throughout the network.

A network of computers can confirm the transaction.

When it is confirmed a transaction is added to a block

The blocks are linked together to create a history.

And that's the beauty of it! The process may seem complicated, but it's done in minutes with modern technology. And because technology is advancing rapidly, I expect things to move even more quickly than ever.

A new transaction is added to the system. It is then relayed to a network of computers located around the world. The computers then solve equations to ensure the authenticity of the transaction.

Once a transaction is confirmed, it is placed in a block after the confirmation. All of the blocks are chained together to create a permanent history of every transaction.

How are Blockchains used?

Even though blockchain is integral to cryptocurrency, it has other applications. For example, blockchain can be used for storing reliable data about transactions. Many people confuse blockchain with cryptocurrencies like bitcoin and ethereum.

Blockchain already being adopted by some big-name companies, such as Walmart, AIG, Siemens, Pfizer, and Unilever. For example, IBM's Food Trust uses blockchain to track food's journey before reaching its final destination.

Although some of you may consider this practice excessive, food suppliers and manufacturers adhere to the policy of tracing their products because bacteria such as E. coli and Salmonella have been found in packaged foods. In addition, there have been isolated cases where dangerous allergens such as peanuts have accidentally been introduced into certain products.

Tracing and identifying the sources of an outbreak is a challenging task that can take months or years. Thanks to the Blockchain, however, companies now know exactly where their food has been—so they can trace its location and prevent future outbreaks.

Blockchain technology allows systems to react much faster in the event of a hazard. It also has many other uses in the

White House releases Trump's national AI plan and framework

Ashley Gold · Axios

The Trump administration's highly anticipated recommendations for Congress on AI offer lawmakers a list of priorities rather than a concrete legislative plan.

Why it matters: Though the framework marks a starting point from the White House, it will be incredibly hard for Congress to pass anything like it — even with Republicans in control.

Disagreements over AI policy go well beyond Republican vs. Democrat, and they overlap with broader tech policy debates that Congress has never been able to solve.

Friction point: The four-page framework calls on lawmakers to limit the ability of states to set their own rules for the technology, setting up a renewed clash with states and Congress over the future of AI regulation.

It's not tied to any specific bills and doesn't resolve long-standing issues around protecting kids and overriding state law.

What's inside: The framework says Congress should “pre-empt state AI laws that impose undue burdens to ensure a minimally burdensome national standard consistent with these recommendations, not fifty discordant ones.”

The proposal calls on Congress to:

Address the use of AI replicas that simulate someone's likeness or voice.

Codify President Trump's pledge to require tech companies to pay for their increased energy demands.

Establish “regulatory sandboxes” to allow developers to experiment with AI under relaxed rules.

It also focuses on kids' online safety: “AI services and platforms must take measures to protect children, while empowering parents to control their children's digital environment and upbringing,” the framework states.

Our thought bubble: It's a sign that this move is about the White House staking out a position and pointing to the framework as a demonstration it tried to set the rules of the road, rather than advancing a bill.

The White House's biggest efforts on AI policy are focused on squashing state efforts to regulate the technology.

Between the lines: The framework says the Trump administration “believes that training of AI models on copyrighted material does not violate copyright laws” and recommends against wading into the legal fights between artists and creators.

The White House wants the judiciary to ultimately decide what is and isn't legal around AI and copyright. But that won't be decided by a single case, and will have different implications depending on the copyright holder.

The framework also appears to give AI developers cover for people using their products for unlawful uses, directing states not to legislate there.

That has echoes of Big Tech's liability shield, Section 230, which protects platforms from being held responsible for what users post and remains controversial 30 years after passage.

House GOP leadership and key committee chairs said they “look forward to working across the aisle” on a national AI framework “that unleashes the full potential of AI, cements the U. S. as the global leader, and provides important protections for American families.”

Meanwhile, dozens of House Democrats — including Reps. Ted Lieu (D-Calif.) and Don Beyer (D-Va.), who are both active on AI issues — introduced a bill Friday that would repeal Trump's December executive order aimed at overriding state AI laws.

There are plans for a companion bill in the Senate from Sen. Brian Schatz (D-Hawaii).

“Until federal action ensures safe and responsible AI development, deployment, and use, states must retain the ability to implement policies to protect the American public,” Beyer said in a release.

The bottom line: It will be difficult for congressional Republicans to square everything the White House wants in one bill that gets bipartisan support, but the administration has now set the contours of the legislative debate.

Republican infighting and bipartisan fractures are sure to come as lawmakers are left with the same issues under a renewed directive from the top.

This story has been updated with additional reporting.

Trump extends deadline for Iran negotiations

Barak Ravid · Axios

President Trump extended the deadline for negotiations with Iran and paused his threat to bomb Iranian energy facilities by another 10 days.

Why it matters: The Trump administration through a group of mediators, Pakistan, Egypt and Turkey, has asked Tehran to hold a high-level meeting this week to discuss a U. S. proposal for ending the war.

Trump's initial five-day pause on strikes against Iranian energy infrastructure was supposed to expire Saturday, and a dramatic military escalation will grow more likely if no progress is made in diplomatic talks, particularly if the Strait of Hormuz remains closed.

The Pentagon is developing military options for a "final blow" in Iran that could include ground forces and a massive bombing campaign, Axios previously reported.

What he's saying: "As per Iranian Government request, please let this statement serve to represent that I am pausing the period of Energy Plant destruction by 10 Days to Monday, April 6, 2026, at 8 P. M., Eastern Time", Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He added that "talks are ongoing and ... are going very well".

Between the lines: Trump made the announcement some 10 minutes after the stock market closed follow-

ing its worst single day of the war.

Oil prices fell quickly on the post, too, but snapped back sharply within minutes and the global benchmark Brent crude was hovering around \$107 a barrel on Thursday evening.

Driving the news: White House envoy Steve Witkoff said on Thursday during a Cabinet meeting that in recent days Pakistan, Egypt and Turkey had approached the U. S. and proposed to mediate.

The U. S. gave Iran through Pakistan a "15-point action list the forms the framework for a peace deal," Witkoff said.

"This has resulted in strong and positive talks ... we will see where things lead and if we can convince Iran that this is the inflection point with no good alternatives for them other than more death and destruction. We have strong signs that this is a possibility," he said.

Witkoff claimed "Iran is looking for an off-ramp" from the war and noted that he communicated to an Iranian official that they shouldn't "miscalculate again."

State of play: A source with knowledge of the mediation efforts said despite public statement rejecting the U. S. proposal, Iranian officials have made it clear they are interested in negotiations.

At the same time, the Iranians officials still haven't given a final response to the proposal to hold a high-level meeting with the U. S. in the coming days

Trump's name is headed to dollar bills as cash use continues to decline

Kelly Tyko · Axios

President Trump's signature is set to appear on U. S. currency — a first for a sitting president — as Americans use physical cash less than ever.

Why it matters: Cash still carries outsized symbolic power — even as its role in everyday payments shrinks.

Driving the news: The Treasury Department plans to put Trump's signature on all new U. S. paper currency, tied to the nation's 250th anniversary in 2026.

Traditionally, U. S. bills carry the signatures of the Treasury secretary and treasurer — not the president.

State of play: Cash accounts for just 14% of U. S. payments, per the Federal Reserve.

Americans make about seven cash payments a month out of roughly 48 total.

Even when it's used, cash is often a fallback — two-thirds of cash payments come from people who prefer cards.

Meanwhile, making exact change is getting harder. Trump ordered the Treasury in February 2025 to stop making new pennies, calling it a way to "rip the waste out of the budget." The U. S. Mint struck the last circulating penny in November.

Yes, but: Not all cash isn't disappearing — and in fact its role has stabilized.

Its use has leveled off in recent years, suggesting a "floor," according to Federal Reserve data.

And more than 80% of Americans use cash at least occasionally, underscoring its staying power.

The big picture: The Trump signature plan is part of a broader push to reshape how Americans think about money — even as physical money itself is changing.

A federal panel recently approved a 24-karat gold commemorative coin featuring Trump's image.

What's next: The first \$100 bills with Trump's signature are expected to be printed in June, Reuters reported, followed by other bills in subsequent months.

It could take weeks for the new bills to circulate through banks — even as fewer Americans use cash.

More from Axios:

Exclusive: Starbucks data shows Americans loading up with protein

Amazon adds FedEx Office to growing returns network

USPS proposes fuel surcharge as Iran war drives up shipping costs

How Government and Business Can Tackle Big Global Crises Together

Harvard Business Review

It feels like a moment of panic for many. While there were some success stories in how public and private sector leaders managed the global pandemic, it isn't over, and many more crises – from political polarization to climate change to new technological threats – loom. But one leading political scientist is hopeful that countries and corporations can find ways to overcome their divisions and better collaborate on our most pressing issues over next ten years. He points to historic precedents and makes specific recommendations for the future, noting that in areas where political divisions cause roadblocks, it will be up to corporate leaders to ensure progress.

Ian Bremmer is the president and founder of the Eurasia Group and author of the book “The Power of Crisis: How Three Threats – and Our Response – Will Change the World.”

How to Lead with Courage in Chaotic Times

Harvard Business Review

Courage involves taking bold action despite uncertainty and fear. In a volatile business environment, it's hard to be brave. But Ranjay Gulati, a professor at Harvard Business School, says that there are strategies any of us can use to get improve our ability to make smart bets on the future. He's studied dozens of leaders across industries and explains how they embolden themselves and their organizations by building a positive narrative around the mission, cultivating self-confidence, stepping their way into a better understanding of the situation, finding connection, and staying calm. Gulati wrote the HBR article “Now is the Time for Courage” and the book *How To Be Bold: The Surprising Science of Everyday Courage*.

When Your Employee Is Underperforming

Harvard Business Review

Many managers struggle with initiating difficult conversations around an individual's subpar performance. Often, leaders wait way too long to sit down with an employee who isn't meeting expectations. Leadership coach Jenny Fernandez says that increasing the frequency of feedback and consciously developing better relationships with direct reports help make these conversations easier to start. And she shares how the right preparation, tone, and open-minded approach lead to more effective discussions that improve not just the one-on-one relationship, but also team morale and turnover rates. Fernandez is the author of the HBR article “How to Talk to an Employee Who Isn't Meeting Expectations.”

What Black Leaders Bring to the Table

Harvard Business Review

Chad Sanders, a former tech executive and entrepreneur, says that people of color, especially Black men like him, often feel the need to assimilate to white corporate culture. They learn to code switch and downplay their race. But Sanders realized a few years into his career that, by trying to fit in, he was failing to leverage the strengths he'd developed growing up as a minority in the United States. After digging into the stories of successful Black leaders, he discovered some common threads to their leadership styles, including empathy, resilience and creative thinking, and he has advice for rising Black executives who want to put those attributes to work as well as the organizations who employ them.

Sanders is the author of “Black Magic: What Black Leaders Learned from Trauma and Triumph.”

“A balancing paradigm I often look at is Starcraft”: Total War: Medieval 3 won't lean too hard on rock-paper-scissors combat, says creative director

Edwin Evans-Thirlwell · Rock Paper Shotgun

Creative Assembly's *Total War* games offer up a wide spread of factions, from rampaging Gauls to furtive and disgusting Wood Elves, but they're all a little beholden to the ancient game of rock-paper-scissors: spears beat cavalry, cavalry beat swords, swords beat spears.

I think Creative Assembly generally do an impressive job of softening that triangular countering logic by means of terrain considerations, flanking, morale and other supporting mechanics. Cavalry won't necessarily beat swords if the cavalry are all tuckered out and spooked. And then you have wildcards, like heroes and war machines, who can mess with the logic more dramatically: Rock paper Mortis Engine! Still, I can't deny that I often feel drained on firing up a DLC-fresh *Total War* army and realising that, yep, I'm roshamboing again.

[Read more](#)

IN BRIEF

Max Rego, The Hill (general): Pope Leo XIV on Sunday said that God “does not listen to the prayers” of individuals who start wars, as the U. S.-Israeli conflict with Iran continues. “Brothers and sisters, this is our God: Jesus, King of Peace, who rejects war, whom no one can use to justify war,” the first American pope, citing a Bible...

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Former U. S. President Bill Clinton and author James Patterson discuss their new novel, *The President is Missing*, in which a fictional president fights a cybersecurity attack amid intense political dysfunction. The coauthors share their lessons for collaborating across disparate skillsets — “clarity on the objective” and “don’t be afraid to admit what you don’t know.” They also talk about their research into cybersecurity threats and how realistic their thriller scenario could be.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Deloitte national managing director Kim Christfort talks about the different personality styles in an organization and the challenges of bringing them together. Her firm has developed a classification system to help companies better understand personality styles and capitalize on their cognitive diversity. She and Suzanne M. Johnson Vickberg coauthored the article, “Pioneers, Drivers, Integrators, and Guardians” in the March-April 2017 issue of *Harvard Business Review*.

José Olivares, The Guardian: Senator’s comments come amid growing divisions within the party, which he says has ‘too small of a coalition’

Cory Booker, the Democratic senator from New Jersey, renewed his calls for new leadership of the Democratic party, saying the party has “failed this moment”.

“As a whole, our party has failed this moment,” Booker said on Sunday. “I’ve called for a generational renewal, because this left-right divide is killing our country and our adversaries know it.” He also said that “purity tests” within the party have led to more division in the US.

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BBC News, BBC News: Having recovered from brain surgery and battled PTSD, an emotional Gary Woodland seals his first win in seven years at the Houston Open.

Mark Warren, Rock Paper Shotgun: Around the turn of the new year, *Fallout: London* developers Team FOLON teased plans to drop the second of the brilliantly British *Fallout 4* mod’s second DLC in early 2026, assuming no hiccups got in the way of those plans. Sadly, it seems that’s exactly what’s happened, necessitating the “skeletal crew” still working on the mod to push *Last Orders* beyond a projected April release window.

Read more

Ben Schoon, 9to5Google:

Roughly a year after the effort was announced, the Apple-developed coding language, Swift, has just launched support for Android.

more...

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: For the qualities that top-performing CEOs have in common, research shows some surprising results. It turns out that charisma, confidence, and pedigree all have little bearing on CEO success. Elena Botelho, partner at leadership advisory firm ghSMART and coleader of its CEO Genome Project, studied high performers in the corner office. The analysis found that they demonstrated four business behaviors: quick decision making, engaging for impact, adapting proactively, and delivering reliably. Botelho cowrote the HBR article “What Sets Successful CEOs Apart.”

Tara Suter, The Hill (general): Rep. Yassamin Ansari (D-Ariz.), who is Iranian American, said President Trump needs to find an off-ramp for the ongoing U. S. conflict with Iran soon. “We’re already in this war, so what can be done? And I’ve been thinking a lot about that. Ultimately, I do think we need an off-ramp, quickly, to the war. We...

Helena Smith in Athens, and agencies, The Guardian: Survivors tell coastguard smugglers ordered victims to be thrown overboard after six days adrift in boat from Libya

Two Sudanese men, believed by Greek authorities to have been behind a smuggling operation in which 22 people were “systematically” thrown overboard after succumbing to days without food or water at sea, have been ordered to appear before a local court on Crete.

Accused of illegally trafficking scores of would-be migrants into the south-eastern European country from Libya, the duo were given 48 hours to prepare to testify before an investigating magistrate on Monday.

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Ben Schoon, 9to5Google:

Some Google Pixel and Samsung Galaxy users have been running into problems with Android Auto as of late, but fixes are now rolling out, Google says.

more...

Mark Warren, Rock Paper Shotgun: *Diablo-ish* *Minecraft* spin-off *Minecraft Dungeons* has a sequel, and said sequel’s coming out at some point in 2026. What’s it about? Well, Mojang say, “all was well until it wasn’t”. Wait, lads, that’s pretty much the setup for every sequel and arguably story humanity’s ever produced. Aye, Mojang say, but the mild-mannered villagers are on fire, so you’d better get your diamond sword polished.

Read more

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Job interviews can feel more like a stylized ritual than a normal conversation. Business writer and journalist Gal Fussman, who’s interviewed scores of people from Mikhail Gorbachev to Jeff Bezos to Dr. Dre, gives us his advice: from how to build trust with a subject to getting an honest answer to a tough question, and also how to stand out in the interview.

90 Lifetime membership: \$129 Pros It offers you products that come with sales pages and those without sales pages.

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